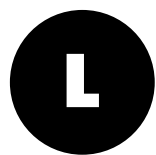


REINING IN AI

AS AI ADOPTION ACCELERATES ACROSS SECTORS, INDIA'S AI GOVERNANCE ROAD MAP AIMS TO BALANCE INNOVATION WITH SAFETY, ACCOUNTABILITY AND STRATEGIC AUTONOMY

BY NIDHI SINGAL



LAST YEAR, some social media users came across an advertisement featuring Union Finance Minister Nirmala Sitharaman endorsing an investment plan.

It turned out that the hyper-realistic promo was fake, had been generated using Artificial Intelligence (AI) and Indian citizens who unsuspectingly clicked on an embedded hyperlink, which led to a fraudulent trading platform, had fallen prey to a scam.

Rewind to 2018. The e-commerce giant Ama-

zon abandoned an AI-powered recruiting tool after it was found to be biased against female candidates. The flaw had become embedded in the system from years of data skewed towards men.

Separated by time, geography and context, the episodes had one common link: AI operating without guardrails. They weren't outliers, but early indicators of what happens when AI evolves faster than the rules meant to rein it in.

The Amazon experience served as an early warning of what happens when algorithms in-

THE BIG PICTURE

▶ The Indian AI market is pegged to reach \$17 billion by 2027, as per a Nasscom-BCG study

▶ AI adoption could inject up to \$1.7 trillion into the economy by 2035, says the NITI Aayog

▶ To bolster India's efforts, ₹10,731 crore has been allocated for the IndiaAI Mission over five years

▶ National compute capacity has crossed 38,000 GPUs under the IndiaAI Mission

▶ The mission is also supporting more than 500 PhDs, 8,000 undergraduates, 5,000 postgraduates

▶ At the same time, India is becoming a hub for global capability centres

